

Sports Fans: Measuring Degree of Identification with Their Team

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While the degree to which spectators identify with sports teams may mediate fan reactions, a valid and reliable measure of team identification has not been available for use in research. The current article reports on the construction of such a scale. Several behavioral, affective, and cognitive reactions among sports spectators are used to validate the team identification measure. Persons who strongly identify with a specific sports team, relative to those spectators moderate or low in identification, report more involvement with the team, display a more ego-enhancing pattern of attributions for the team's successes, have more positive expectations concerning future team performances, exhibit greater willingness to invest larger amounts of time and money in order to watch the team play, and are more likely to believe that fans of the team they are identified with possess special qualities. Discussion focuses on the implications of elevated levels of in group favoritism on the part of highly identified sports fans for acceptance of aggressive behavior, self-serving attributional processes, and the development of spectator friendships. Suggestions for future research using the team identification measure are presented.

KEY WORDS: Attribution, Spectators, Team allegiance.

Social science research on sports spectators has focused primarily on spectator violence (e.g., Atyeo, 1979; Russell, 1981; Smith, 1983; Wann

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& Branscombe, 1990a). Little empirical research has been directed toward individual differences among sports spectators in terms of their level of commitment or identification with a particular team. For the most part, all spectators have been viewed as similar. That is, the various potential differences between spectators who identify strongly with a team and those who do not have not been examined. Yet, it is quite obvious that some fans identify with a particular team more than other spectators. Indeed, Pooley (1978) suggested that casual sports spectators simply observe an athletic event and when it is over, they soon forget about it. On the other hand, the committed sports fan, "continues his interest until the intensity of feeling toward the team becomes so great that parts of every day are devoted to either his team or in some instances, to the broad realm of sports in general" (Pooley, 1978, p. 14). Individuals who are deeply committed to a sports team should differ from the less identified in terms of their investment of time and money, attendance records at performances, and attributional patterns for game outcomes. A short but reliable measure of team identification could be used to explore additional ways in which their behaviors and experiences differ. The validation of such an identification measure is described in this article.

Some theorists have speculated that a spectator's level of identification with a team may moderate his/her responses. One example can be found in Sloan's (1979) review of the basking-in-reflected-glory (BIRGING) literature. In this research it has been found that individuals often attempt to increase their self-esteem by decreasing the psychological distance between themselves and successful others (Cialdini, Borden, Thorne, Walker, Freedman, & Sloan, 1976; Cialdini & De Nicholas, 1989; Cialdini & Richardson, 1980), and protect their self-image by denouncing their associations with unsuccessful groups or individuals (termed cutting-off-reflected-failure or CORFing, see Snyder, Lassegard, & Ford, 1986). Sloan notes, however, that even after defeat some individuals maintain their allegiance to the team. Using the team identification measure to be described here, we have found that highly identified spectators are in fact less likely to decrease their association with the team or denounce their loyalty than are moderately or less identified persons (Wann & Branscombe, 1990b). It appears that highly identified fans can remain committed to their team even after many defeats (i.e., the long suffering fans of the Chicago Cubs and Boston Red Sox professional baseball teams in the U.S.).

Branscombe and Wann (1991a) have demonstrated several cognitive and affective responses that are modified by the individual's level of identification with an individual who represents a group that has important

implications for the viewer's social identity. Those persons high in identification exhibited greater physiological arousal during the competition than did those low in identification. Furthermore, the amount of identification with the group that the athletic contender represented (the U.S.), in addition to arousal increases, predicted the amount of derogation that was directed toward the opposition fan group. There are also potentially positive social consequences of sport team identification. Branscombe and Wann (1991b) obtained a significant positive correlation between level of identification with a university basketball team or a professional baseball team and feelings of self-worth and life satisfaction. Negative relationships between amount of identification with these teams and depression and alienation were observed.

Schurr, Wittig, Ruble, and Ellen (1988) argue that degree of identification with the team should be related to sporting event attendance. Other work in social-cognitive psychology on ingroup identification and social identity theory concludes that identification with a group is an important determinant of many types of behavior (Brewer, 1979; Tajfel, 1981; Turner, 1978). For example, individuals consistently show favoritism toward ingroup members and derogation of outgroup members, with such different responses serving to maintain and enhance feelings of self-esteem (Crocker & Luhtanen, 1990; Crocker, Thompson, McGraw, & Ingerman, 1987; Oakes & Turner, 1980).

Amount of identification with a team can potentially exert several different effects on behavior. The purpose of the present research was to develop a measure assessing individual allegiance or identification with a sports team, and then demonstrate its reliability and validity. In Study 1, the factor structure and reliability of the new measure is examined. Study 2 validates the measure by demonstrating consistent differences among fans who vary in their level of identification with the team on several behavior, cognitive, and affective dimensions. In the present research, four general categories of spectator responses were examined: amount of involvement with the team, attributions about the team's accomplishments, amount of investment of time and money in team activities, and the extent to which other spectators of the team are perceived as special or bonded in some manner.

As Smith, Patterson, Williams, and Hogg (1981) have proposed, directly committed fans are likely to be involved (behaviorally and affectively) with the team. Thus, variables such as how long the individual has been a fan, as well as how many games attended were examined. Biased attributions have also been shown among spectators. Generally, it has been found

that after a successful competition spectators report internal, stable attributions for the game outcome, although situational factors are seen as the cause of defeats (Grove, Hanrahan, & McInman, 1991; Hastorf & Cantril, 1954; Lau & Russell, 1980). However, this self-serving attributional tendency may be even more pronounced among individuals who are highly identified with the team because the team's accomplishments have evaluative implications for the spectator's identity. Furthermore, it is expected that highly allegiant fans will be more willing to invest greater amounts of time and money in order to see their team perform. Mann (1979) and Melnick (1989) have noted that the most loyal and committed fans are those who are willing to stand in long ticket lines. Thus, they should be willing to pay the greatest amount of money for tickets. Finally, while it has never been empirically tested, it has been suggested that highly identified spectators feel a sense of bonding with one another (Zillmann, Bryant, & Sapolsky, 1979). Indicators of this effect might be the degree to which highly identified persons see fans of the team as special in some way and choose friends who are also fans of this team (someone who shares this common identity).

Finally, spectators of college teams, as opposed to those of professional leagues, were studied. Several authors have indicated that the most highly identified fans are those supporting college teams (Goldstein & Arms, 1971; Schurr, Ruble, & Ellen, 1985; Zillmann et al., 1979). Leuck, Krahenbuhl, and Odenkirk (1979) found pre- to post-game increases in aggression for college students, although increases were not obtained for non-student spectators. High levels of identification are not, by any means, restricted to college sports teams however. Guttman (1986), for example, concluded that athletes of national teams come to represent the nation itself among highly identified fans. We would therefore expect our measure to be applicable to many different types and levels of sports teams, although the most extreme identification scores may be found for college teams.

Study 1

METHOD

Subjects and Procedure. Undergraduates (75 males, 113 females) attending the University of Kansas participated in this study as partial fulfillment for an introductory psychology course requirement. Their mean age was 18.5 years. Subjects completed a 7 item questionnaire designed to measure their level of identification with the University of Kansas men's varsity basketball team. In addition, a random sample of 49 (25 males, 24 females)

of these subjects were contacted one year later and they completed the questionnaire a second time in order to determine the test-retest reliability of the instrument.

RESULTS

Each question was scored using a Likert-scale format, with end points from 1 to 8. Higher numbers represented greater amounts of allegiance. For this sample, the mean score on the total scale was 56.20 ($SD = 1.3$). Scores on this measure, or any of the results reported in this work, do not differ by subject gender. Two analyses were conducted to determine whether it was appropriate to sum the seven items to form a single in-

TABLE 1
Factor Loadings and Alpha Coefficients if that Item were Deleted from the Scale for the Team Identification Measure in Study 1 and 2.

Item	Factor Loadings		Alpha if Deleted	
	Study 1	Study 2	Study 1	Study 2
How important to YOU is it that the K.U. basketball team wins? (Not Important/Very Important)	.883	.813	.87	.91
How strongly do YOU see YOURSELF as a fan of the K.U. basketball team? (Not At all A Fan/Very Much A Fan)	.903	.912	.87	.90
How strongly do your FRIENDS see YOU as a fan of the K.U. basketball team? (Not At All A Fan/Very Much A Fan)	.905	.893	.86	.90
During the season, how closely do you follow the K.U. basketball team via ANY of the following: a) in person or on television, b) on the radio, or c) television news or a newspaper? (Never/Almost Every Day)	.754	.796	.89	.92
How important is being a fan of K.U. basketball to YOU? (Not Important/Very Important)	.901	.913	.87	.90
How much do YOU dislike K.U. basketball's greatest rivals? (Do Not Dislike/Dislike Very Much)	.583	.634	.92	.93
How often do YOU display the K.U. basketball team's name or insignia at your place of work, where you live, or on your clothing? (Never/Always)	.713	.714	.89	.93
Eigenvalue for Factor 1	4.64	4.68		
Percent of Variance Accounted for	66.3	66.9		

Note: Responses for each item were on a 1 to 8 scale. The anchors for the response scales are in parentheses following each item.

of team identification. First, the internal consistency of the scale was assessed. Cronbach's standardized reliability coefficient was .91. All of the items were significantly inter-correlated and the average item-total correlation was .59. Second, a principle components factor analysis yielded a single factor accounting for 66.3% of the total variance. Factor loadings for each of the items and the alphas if each item was deleted are shown in Table I.

The test-retest reliability of the measure was determined by computing the correlation between scores at Time 1 ($M = 6.42$; $SD = 1.32$) and Time 2 ($N = 5.99$; $SD = 1.16$). The test-retest coefficient for the one year period was significant, $r(49) = .60$, $p < .001$. While the value of this reliability estimate is somewhat modest, the interval between the two administrations of the scale was unusually long.

DISCUSSION

From both the reliability analysis and the factor analysis it was apparent that the scale was indeed an internally consistent and unidimensional measure. All 7 items were clearly assessing the same construct, presumably allegiance to the team. Furthermore, scores on the scale remained quite consistent, over the period of one year. The second study was then conducted in order to test the predictive validity of the measure. Specifically, spectators' involvement and investment with the team, attributions for team success, expectations concerning the outlook for the team, and the extent to which fans of this team were perceived as possessing special qualities were examined by level of team identification.

Study 2

METHOD

Subjects and Procedure. In the second study, a new sample of 358 introductory psychology students (175 males, 183 females) from the University of Kansas received partial course credit in exchange for their participation. Their mean age was 18.9 years. Each subject completed the identification measure as well as a questionnaire designed to assess subjects' reactions and behaviors toward the University's basketball team.

Level of Identification. Subjects' overall identification with the basketball team was determined by computing a mean score on the identification measure. Scores could range from 1.0 to 8.0 with higher numbers representing greater amounts of identification. As with Study 1, the consistency of the items was quite high, standardized alpha = .93. In addition, a principle components factor analysis indicated that a single factor accounted for

66.9% of the total variance. As can be seen in Table I, the factor loadings for each item were quite similar across the two samples.

Design of the Study. A tripartite split was performed on the identification measure in order to develop three groups: high, moderate, and low identifiers. The mean level of identification was 7.15 ($SD = .41$; $N = 131$), 5.88 ($SD = .39$; $N = 119$), and 3.55 ($SD = 1.07$; $N = 118$) in the three groups, respectively. An analysis of variance indicated that there were differences between the groups, $F(2,355) = 849.84$, $p < .001$, and subsequent contrasts revealed that the means for each of the three groups were significantly different from one another. The study was a 3×2 between-subjects factorial design. There were three levels of identification: high, moderate, and low and both male and female participants were examined.

Dependent Variables. Four components of fan commitment or involvement were examined: the extent and length of involvement with the team, attributions for the team's current standing and outlook for the remainder of the season, amount of money and time they would be willing to invest in the team as well as actual amounts previously invested, extent to which fans see other fans of the team as "special" in some way and whether they wanted their friends to be fans of this team also.

RESULTS

Spectator Involvement with the Team. To assess whether identification level is related to amount of involvement with the team, a mixed-factor MANOVA was conducted with repeated measures on the number of years each subject reported being a fan of the team, the number of home games each individual expected to attend during the 1989-1990 season, and the likelihood that he/she would attend an away game. A significant interaction between item type and level of identification, $F(4, 355) = 17.13$, $p < .001$, qualified the significant main effect of identification, $F(2, 355) = 104.79$, $p < .001$.¹ On all of the measures, subjects high in identification were much more involved with the team than were other subjects. The univariate tests for the individual items were significant, with all p 's $< .001$. A priori contrasts performed on the means shown in Table II indicated that the three identification groups differed significantly from each other on all three items.

Spectator Attributions About the Team. The second set of questions was designed to test the hypothesis that team success would be attributed to

¹ This interaction (as well as the significant interactions on the involvement and "special" MANOVAs) is not surprising, nor is it especially interesting in light of the fact that the items in this MANOVA involved different response scales. While subjects are, regardless of identification, more likely to attend home rather than away games, persons high in identification are more likely to attend both home and away games relative to other subjects.

TABLE II
Means on the Involvement, Attribution, Investment, and Fan Uniqueness Items by Identification Level

Item	Identification Level		
	High	Moderate	Low
<i>Involvement</i>			
Years a Fan ₁	7.42 _a	3.76 _b	1.17 _c
Number of Home Games ₁	11.82 _a	7.80 _b	2.20 _c
Likelihood of Away Games ₁	3.92 _a	3.04 _b	1.50 _c
<i>Attributions and Outlook</i>			
External Attributions ₂	3.04 _a	3.78 _b	3.97 _b
Internal Attributions ₂	6.98 _a	6.51 _b	6.40 _b
Season Outlook ₂	7.82 _a	7.54 _b	7.00 _c
<i>Investment</i>			
Regular Season Ticket ₁	27.36 _a	15.23 _b	8.42 _c
Playoff Ticket ₁	65.75 _a	31.68 _b	16.98 _c
Championship Ticket ₁	125.57 _a	64.64 _b	26.23 _c
Previous Ticket ₁	23.05 _a	21.23 _a	6.87 _c
Willing to Wait in Lines ₁	4.29 _a	3.43 _b	1.97 _c
Have Waited in Lines ₁	2.38 _a	1.54 _b	1.17 _c
<i>Fans Are Special</i>			
Friends Need to be Fans ₁	2.99 _a	2.10 _b	1.33 _c
% of Friends Who are Fans ₁	75.79 _a	70.21 _b	51.41 _c
Fans are Special ₂	5.65 _a	4.47 _b	3.03 _c
Fans are Bonded ₂	6.39 _a	5.67 _b	4.64 _c

Note: Means with different subscripts significantly differ at the .05 level. Higher numbers represent more of each dimension. Responses to items with subscript '1' were open-ended; subscript '2' items were ones using a Likert-scale format ranging from 1 to 8; and items with subscript '3' were open-ended responses converted into a Likert-scale format, with categories from 1 to 7.

internal factors most by those highly identified, followed by the moderate and low identification persons. The reverse pattern was expected for the tendency make external attributions for team success. Expectations for future performance were expected to differ by identification level, with those highest in identification expressing the most positive expectations.

A MANOVA with identification level as the between-subjects factor, and the mean rating given the external factors for the team's success (e.g., luck), ratings concerning the importance of internal factors (e.g., ability of the K.U. players), and mean responses concerning the perceived likelihood of future team successes (e.g., likelihood the team would reach the NCAA playoffs) serving as the three levels of the repeated measures variable. Again a significant multivariate item by identification interaction, F

(4, 355) = 12.15, $p < .001$, qualified the significant main effect of identification, $F(2, 355) = 4.86$, $p < .01$. As shown in Table II, highly identified persons do make fewer external attributions for their team's success, at the same time accepting more internal attributions than do the moderate or low identified individuals. The moderate and low identification groups did not, however, significantly differ from one another. On the future look measure, all means were significantly different from one another.

Spectator Investment in the Team. The third MANOVA assessed whether persons who differ in their level of identification vary in their investment both past and future, in team-related activities. The six levels of the repeated measures factor were: self-report of the greatest sum of money that would be willing to pay to see the University's basketball team play a regular season game, a playoff game, a championship game, the largest amount they had paid in the past to see the team play, the longest amount of time they had waited in line to see the team play, and how long they would be willing to wait in line in the future.

The multivariate main effect of identification was significant, $F(355) = 31.33$, $p < .001$, as was the interaction between item and level of identification, $F(10, 355) = 18.19$, $p < .001$. Identification level had impact on some behaviors than on others. The univariates for identification were significant for all six items (all p 's $< .001$). As shown in Table II, a priori contrasts revealed that with the exception of the question asking for the greatest amount previously paid for a ticket, all means were significantly different from one another. On this question, those moderate and high in identification had previously paid more for a ticket than those low in allegiance, with the individuals in the first two groups not differing reliably.

Spectators Perceiving Other Spectators as Unique. The final MANOVA examined the hypothesis that variations in identification level relate to perception of other fans of the team and to friendship selection patterns. This MANOVA included the between-subjects factor of identification level and four levels of the within-subjects variable — when choosing a friend, how important is it that this person be a fan of the team, the percentage of current friends who are fans of the team, the extent to which fans of this team are special, and the extent to which the team fans are bonded together. In addition to the significant identification main effect, $F(355) = 40.72$, $p < .001$, the analysis indicated a significant item by identification interaction, $F(6, 355) = 26.05$, $p < .001$. Univariate tests revealed that each of the individual items was significant (all p 's $< .001$). The contrasts indicated that all of the identification groups differed significantly

from each other, with the high identified individuals reporting more of each variable than the moderately identified persons, who in turn scored higher than those low in team identification.

General Discussion

In the studies reported here, reliability and validity data were provided for a measure assessing spectators' degree of identification with a sports team. Numerous behavioral, cognitive, and emotional reaction differences were observed for persons who differ in the degree to which they identify with a particular sports team. The measure was found to be reliable and internally consistent with a simple factor structure (Study 1), and it related to other relevant variables as expected (Study 2). Thus, this measure appears to be quite accurate in determining people's allegiance to a team and would be appropriate for use in other studies investigating sports spectators. For example, it would be interesting to measure and compare the identification levels of spectators seated in different parts of the stadium as well as those who are identified with different sports. With a slight modification of the measure, individuals' identification with particular players compared to the team as a whole could be investigated. Indeed, with the high status given to many of today's multi-million dollar players, some spectators may be more highly identified with specific players than with the team itself. A comparison of the scores on the measure when individual star players are the object of identification referred to in the items and when the team is the object would illuminate this issue.

Persons high in identification were more involved and invested in the team, were more positive in their attributions concerning the team's performance and predictions for the future, viewed other spectators as special, and felt it was more important for their friends to be fans of this team, than did those who were moderate or low in identification with the team. This is consistent with Schurr et al. (1987) who found that identification predicted attendance at home games. What as yet remains untested is the contention that highly identified fans actually are more knowledgeable about their team and the sport (Pooley, 1978; Smith et al., 1981). Due to the increased involvement and exposure to the team that the highly identified fans reported in this research, it appears reasonable to expect that persons high in identification will be in fact the most knowledgeable fans — at least for their preferred team. Whether those high in identification with a particular sports team are more knowledgeable about the sport in

general than are those lower in team allegiance is less obvious. This prediction is easily testable using the team identification measure validated here.

Persons high in identification exhibited different attributional patterns relative to those moderate or low in identification. In light of the fact that at the time of Study 2 the team had achieved a strong record, the attributions assessed were for the success as opposed to failure of the team. The data indicate that those who identify strongly with the team relative to the other two groups, attributed the success of the team more to internal factors and less to external causes. While other research (Grove et al., 1991; Hastorf & Cantril, 1954; Lau & Russell, 1980) has found biased attributions among spectators in general, these results indicate that self-enhancing attributions are especially prominent in those who are highly identified with the team. Had the present study been conducted during a losing season then the reverse pattern would be expected with those highly identified with the team showing the most external attributions as explanations for their team's failure. It should be noted that the low and moderate identifiers did not significantly differ in their attributional responses. Perhaps a person has to be highly identified before engaging in ego-enhancing or ego-protecting attributional processes. Previous research has shown that highly identified persons are less likely to disassociate themselves from the team during unsuccessful periods than are those who are lower in team identification (Wann & Branscombe, 1990b). With this coping mechanism of disassociation not being used by them, highly identified spectators may resort to self-serving attributional processes.

Highly allegiant persons were also found to have more favorable expectations about the outlook for the team. Obviously, given this team's strong record, all spectators reported the team's outlook as highly favorable. Indeed, even persons low in identification had a mean of 7.00 on a 1 to 8 scale. Even though those who do not identify very strongly with the team perceived the team's outlook as highly positive, the high identifiers ($M = 7.82$) exhibited a ceiling effect and appeared to perceive the team as unbeatable. A similar set of analyses conducted during an average season, one with an approximately equal number of wins and losses, also would be of interest. Here, the ambiguity concerning the players' performance would be maximal, allowing for the greatest variability in distortion. In these conditions more pronounced differences between the identification groups might be observed. In fact, during a losing season, it is possible that only persons highly identified with the team would see any glimmer of hope for future success.

The third set of analyses revealed that highly identified spectators recall

investing greater amounts of money and time in their attempts to see their team play. While these analyses are based on the individuals' memories of past behaviors and not the actual behaviors themselves, memory for behaviors such as these is usually quite accurate (Ajzen & Fishbein, 1980). With regard to the greatest amount the fans anticipate being willing to pay to witness certain games, it should not be concluded that the spectators would be willing to pay these prices for all games — they were simply asked the greatest amount they would be willing to pay to see the team play one game. What may be concluded is that: a) as identification with a team increases, so does the amount persons are willing to pay; and b) highly identified fans are willing to pay large sums of money to see their team participate in an important game. Finally, the results concerning the length of time spectators have waited in line in the past and believe they would in the future support Mann's (1979) contention that long queues are an appropriate place to study spectators because they consist of highly allegiant fans.

The final set of reactions investigated in this study examined the extent to which the spectators saw other fans as special and bonded together as well as whether or not being a fan is an important characteristic in choosing a friend. The results indicated that highly identified persons are most likely to believe that other fans of their team are special (e.g., a form of ingroup favoritism). It should be mentioned that while significant differences in terms of whether their friends needed to be fans of the team were observed for the three identification groups, overall there was relatively little agreement with this item. Even for persons highly identified with the team it does not appear to be a very important characteristic for friend selection *per se*. However, those highly identified did report having more friends who were fans of this team. An interesting future research endeavor would be to investigate whether or not highly allegiant fans do actually have more friends who are fans. Does a discrepancy on this dimension discourage people from pursuing relationships with persons who differ from them in this important way? It is also possible that due to their own heavy involvement with the team, identified fans overestimate this number or assume certain friends are fans who in fact do not consider themselves as such. People are known to be susceptible to this sort of false consensus effect (Ross, 1977), and highly involved persons may be more so.

Persons who strongly identify with the team also felt that the fans of the team were bonded together. One possible consequence of this sense of bonding is increased categorization of persons into ingroups — spectators supporting the favored team, and outgroups — persons aligned with

the opposing team (Vinokur, 1988). High identification with a particular group may cause individuals to focus attention on the differences between themselves and members of the outgroup (McArthur, 1981). Persons desiring to maintain a positive self-identity through membership in a superior group may then display aggression toward outgroup members (Sherif & Sherif 1961). For sports spectators, this may result in fan violence.

The results reported here clearly indicate that there are many affective, cognitive, and behavioral differences among sports fans. Those who are highly identified exhibit the most extreme responses. What remains unclear is the purpose served by high allegiance to a particular team. The issue, what are the benefits of such high levels of identification? One benefit may involve the enhancement of individual levels of self-esteem. It is likely that fans' self-esteem may be improved in at least two different ways. First, and most obvious, individuals may enhance their self-esteem through associations with successful teams and bask in the glow of that team's victories (Cialdini et al., 1976). Second, on a more sociological level, fans may increase the positivity of their self-concepts as a result of feelings of belongingness. The salience of group memberships has been previously shown to be related to feelings of self-worth (Turner, 1975; Oakes & Turner, 1980). In modern society, many traditional social ties have declined. Spectatorship and team loyalty may replace these older institutional affiliations and increase one's social contacts. Support for these notions has been found. Persons high in identification, relative to those who are lower in team identification, feel less alienated and depressed, and have higher levels of self-esteem (Branscombe & Wann, 1991b).

In conclusion, the measure of spectator identification with a sports team reported here was shown to be a useful and predictive assessment tool. Furthermore, highly, moderately, and less identified persons report different behaviors and feelings with regard to sports perception and conclusion. Due to the obvious differences among these individuals, it appears unwise to study spectators with the assumption that they are all identical. More accurate and informative research could be conducted if identification level were included in the analysis as an independent variable. Although reasonable test-retest reliability over a period of one year was observed for the particular team used as the object of identification here, identification with a team could be analyzed as a dependent variable as well. By investigating those factors which lead to increases and/or decreases in identification with a team, perhaps through a longitudinal study, more would be learned about the antecedents and consequences of sports team identification.

RESUMÉ

Les Auteurs proposent une échelle de mesure, qui au moment n'existe pas, pour étudier le problème des mœurs qui s'identifient à leur équipe et ils vont exposer des hypothèses sur une probable future réalisation.

On a utilisé à tel but les réactions affectives et de connaissance de la conduite des spectateurs des sports d'équipe pour confirmer une mesure de leur identification à l'équipe. Les personnes qui s'identifient passionnément à l'équipe s'impliquent davantage, ils ont d'attentes plus positives à l'égard des performances futures, ils manifestent une grande intention d'investir plus d'argent et de temps pour la suivre en comparaison à ceux qui vont s'identifier à l'équipe d'une façon modérée ou insuffisante. Il est fort probable que les plus engagés repoussent qu'ils ont de qualités particulières. La discussion s'arrête sur les implications dérivantes du niveau élevé de préférence entre-groupe, en relation à l'acceptation d'attitudes agressives, aux procès d'attribution et au développement des relations d'amitié entre les spectateurs.

RESUMEN

Los autores se proponen una escala de medida, que actualmente no existe, para estudiar el problema de la identificación de los aficionados con su propio equipo y plantean unas hipótesis sobre el posible empleo de esta escala en futuro.

Por esta razón se utilizaron las reacciones comportamentales, afectivas y cognitivas de los espectadores de los deportes de equipo, para poder validar una medida de identificación con el equipo mismo.

Los individuos que se identifican mucho con el equipo, respecto a aquellos que se identifican moderada o escasamente, son mayormente implicados, tienen expectativas más positivas por lo que concierne las futuras prestaciones y demuestran mayor deseo de dedicar tiempo y dinero para poderlo seguir y además probablemente creen que los aficionados del mismo equipo tengan calidades especiales.

La discusión se detiene sobre las implicaciones que derivan del elevado nivel de preferencias intra-grupo en relación a la aceptación de comportamientos agresivos, a procedimientos de atribución y al desarrollo de relaciones de amistad entre los espectadores.

ZUSAMMENFASSUNG

Die Autoren stellen hier einen bis heute noch nicht definierten Maßstab zur Untersuchung des Identifikationsphänomens des Fußballfans mit seiner Mannschaft vor und legen einige Beispiele für dessen Anwendungsmöglichkeiten dar.

Zu diesem Zweck wurden einige behavioristische, emotions- und erkenntnisgebundene Reaktionen von Seiten der Zuschauer von Mannschaftsspielen eingesetzt, anhand derer ein Maßstab zur Benennung des Identifikationsprozesses mit der Mannschaft gearbeitet werden konnte.

Menschen, die sich in höherem Grad mit ihrer Mannschaft identifizieren — im Verhältnis also zu anderen weit gemäßigter oder nun geringer Identifikation — lassen sich in stärkerem Maße mit hineinziehen, ihre Erwartungen in Bezug auf die zukünftigen Leistungen der Mannschaft sind positiver, sie haben ein stärkeres Bedürfnis, noch mehr Zeit und Geld zu investieren, um die Mannschaftsaktivitäten mitzuverfolgen und mit größerer Wahrscheinlichkeit sind sie der Meinung, daß die Mitglieder ihrer Mannschaft besondere Eigenschaften vorzuweisen haben.

RIASSUNTO

Gli Autori propongono una scala di misurazione, attualmente non esistente, per studiare il problema dell'identificazione dei tifosi con la propria squadra e formano ipotesi sulla sua possibile futura utilizzazione. A tale scopo sono state utilizzate le reazioni comportamentali, affettive e cognitive degli spettatori degli sport di squadra per validare una misura d'identificazione con la squadra. Gli individui che si identificano molto con una squadra, rispetto a quelli che con essa s'identificano in modo moderato o scarso, si coinvolgono maggiormente, hanno aspettative più positive relative alle future prestazioni, manifestano maggiore desiderio d'investire più tempo e denaro per poterla seguire e con più probabilità ritengono che i tifosi della squadra con cui s'identificano posseggano qualità speciali. La discussione si sofferma sulle implicazioni che derivano dall'elevato livello di preferenze intra-gruppo in relazione all'accettazione di comportamenti aggressivi, ai processi di attribuzione e allo sviluppo di rapporti di amicizia fra gli spettatori.

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